



The GoFynd.io team at work in the company's Mumbai office

Initial open source projects on GoFynd.io

- **Fynd API:** This API makes it easy for developers and businesses to build a full-fledged omni-channel fashion e-commerce app.
- **FXI:** This tool provides real-time updates from delivery partners to help businesses monitor their packages.
- **Wit:** This API ensures automatic tagging of all e-commerce-specific catalogue images to organise, manage and search these through the available content.
- **Metricbeat:** This package monitors the host metrics across the server fleet.
- **Gravity View:** This tool helps developers to enable tilt-to-browse support on their apps, to show product images to users without the need for any swiping gesture

developers building new projects using existing code," says Shah. The co-founder has developed a concrete plan to release one new open source project and improve one existing project every month, in order to actively receive contributions from developers.

Scalable options

Just like any other open source-focused enterprise, Fynd doesn't rely much on proprietary solutions. Instead, the company is planning to scale up using open source developments. "By using techniques that are already available, we significantly reduce the time

taken to deploy, go live and scale," says Shah.

Apart from utilising the publicly developed solutions to build the online marketplace, Fynd has adapted open source to power its mobile apps as well as its artificial intelligence (AI) driven fashion-discovery and transaction bot. "We have used a lot of open source technologies in almost every aspect of our products," Shah, 28, tells *Open Source For You*. There are libraries, models, and algorithms written by developers across the world that help Fynd build a great online shopping experience.

The challenges in adopting ready-made solutions

One of the major challenges that Fynd has faced while opting for open source is to contextually match the code with the use case. "Sometimes, adapting the available technique to fit our particular problem or use case can be tricky. You can't always use the same code, algorithm or the library as it is," explains Shah.

Fynd tries to resolve this challenge by understanding the context in which the code was initially written. The company also reaches out directly to the contributor to better understand the use case. This helps to reduce costs and the time spent in building and refining the final product.

Advice to other startups

Shah believes that open source has always been a key way of development for all startups. "With so much knowledge being open sourced, it is only going to fuel the use of such technologies. Everyone can't build everything from scratch. Therefore, knowledge gained and shared by someone can be a good foundation, a 'leap-frog' point, without having to reinvent the wheel," he concludes. 

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